

When we first got married, we had no money—to the extent that we even had to borrow from an uncle to help with a deposit for our first home.

Thanks to Barefoot, money is no longer a stress for our family. Still, we don't ever want our kids to be in that position so we are sending them with no shoes down the Barefoot path.

Our eldest son, Damian, has been Barefoot since he was 14 and working in the school canteen.

He would come home from school with six \$2 coins and put them in his jar. When they piled up we would go to the bank and swap them for a \$100 note.

We didn't want our kids to waste their money on bank fees, so we helped them set up three low-cost bank accounts for their savings.

Damian is now 18, working at McDonald's, and still splits his income into his three accounts every week.

Having his own accounts has helped him save for big purchases.

He bought his first parcel of shares when he was 17. He bought his first car with cash—a 2012 Ford Mondeo for \$10 000. And now he's saving up for a house deposit!

But even more important are the lessons he's learned—he now knows how to avoid getting ripped off by banks, and he has the confidence to be able to do whatever he wants without having to borrow money like we did.

We've always wanted our kids to be secure and do better than us. And, with Barefoot, they're on the right track!